Mindanao State University–Tawi-Tawi College of Technology and Oceanography

Mindanao State University–Tawi-Tawi College of Technology and Oceanography (MSU-TCTO) stands as a vital autonomous campus of the Mindanao State University System. Located in the heart of the Sulu Archipelago in Bongao, Tawi-Tawi, it blends academic excellence with a deep commitment to marine sciences, cultural preservation, and community upliftment in one of the Philippines' most remote and biodiverse regions.

The university serves as a beacon for inclusive education, particularly for Muslims and other cultural minorities, while advancing research and sustainable practices tied to the area's rich marine environment. Its tagline, "Creating Opportunities • Transforming Lives," captures its ongoing role in regional development.

Contents

1 History and Founding
2 Etymology
3 Vision, Mission, and Core Values
4 Founders and Early Leadership
5 Institutional and Historical Development
6 Campus and Location
7 Academic Structure
8 Academic Programs and Curriculum Offerings
9 Research, Extension, and Community Engagement
10 Student Life and Organizations
11 Traditions and Culture
12 Administration and Governance
13 Chancellors, or Heads
14 Facilities and Landmarks
15 Accreditation and Recognition
16 Significant Milestones
17 Notable Alumni
18 Notable Faculty
19 Contributions to Education, Society, and the Bangsamoro Community
20 Legacy and Impact
21 Research Assessment

Mindanao State University–Tawi-Tawi College of Technology and Oceanography



Also Known As

MSU-TCTO (https://msutcto.edu.ph/)
Website: https://msutcto.edu.ph/

Type

Public autonomous university campus

Established

1964 (as MSU Preparatory High School, Bongao); formalized as MSU-Sulu College of Technology and Oceanography through Republic Act No. 6060 on August 4, 1969; renamed Tawi-Tawi College of Technology and Oceanography through Batas Pambansa Blg. 197 on March 16, 1982

Location

Boheh Sallang, Sanga-Sanga, Bongao, Tawi-Tawi 7500, Philippines

Affiliation

Mindanao State University System

Chancellor

Mary Joyce Z. Guinto-Sali, PhD (4th regular Chancellor)

Tagline

"Creating Opportunities • Transforming Lives"

Colleges and Institutes

History and Founding

MSU-TCTO's story begins modestly in **1964** as the **Mindanao State University Preparatory High School** in Bongao, an extension of the MSU Marawi Preparatory High School. This early initiative aimed to bring secondary education to the islands.

A major milestone came with Republic Act No. 6060, signed by President Ferdinand Marcos on August 4, 1969. This law created the **MSU-Sulu College of Technology and Oceanography (MSU-SCTO),** focused on fisheries technology degrees and diplomas to support resource exploitation, conservation, fish processing research, and oceanographic studies in the Sulu Seas.

When Tawi-Tawi separated from Sulu as a province in 1973, the institution adapted. Batas Pambansa Blg. 197, signed on March 16, 1982, renamed it the **Tawi-Tawi College of Technology and Oceanography** and formalized its place as an **autonomous campus in the MSU System**. Full autonomy as a university campus solidified around 1990.

Expansion included more secondary schools across island municipalities from 1967 to 1977, reaching about 20 by 1990. In 1984, the MSU-TCTO Science High School and Child Development Center – Laboratory Elementary School opened, broadening its basic education footprint.

Etymology

The name reflects its geographic and academic focus. "Tawi-Tawi" honors the province, while "College of Technology and Oceanography" underscores its original mandate in technical and marine fields. Earlier iterations tied it to "Sulu" before provincial division necessitated the change.

College of Arts and Social Sciences (CASS), College of Islamic Arts and Sciences (CIAS), College of Education (COED), College of Business, Accountancy, and Management (CBAM), College of Mathematical Sciences (CMS), College of Fisheries, Oceanography, Environmental Science, and Technology (COFEST), College of Computer Studies (CCS), College of Law (COL)

Accreditation

AACCUP Level II, ISO 9001:2015 (including College of Law), CHED Certificates of Program Compliance

Notability

The only oceanography and fisheries-focused university campus in the Sulu Archipelago, ranking among the top Philippine higher education institutions in the Times Higher Education Sustainability Impact Ratings for SDG 14 (Life Below Water)

Known For

Producing graduates in marine biology, fisheries, education, and Islamic studies while advancing inclusive education for Muslim and indigenous communities in one of the country's most remote and biodiverse regions

Pull Quote

"From a small high school in Bongao to a beacon of marine science and inclusive education, MSU-TCTO has spent six decades transforming the Sulu Archipelago, one graduate at a time."

Vision, Mission, and Core Values

The university envisions itself as a center of excellence in fisheries, oceanography, marine sciences, and related disciplines, responsive to southern Philippines' socio-economic, peace, and development needs. It positions itself as a renowned institution in the Sulu Archipelago for marine and environmental science, driving sustainable development.

Its mission centers on delivering globally competitive instruction, research, extension, and production in these areas, with emphasis on quality education for Muslims and indigenous groups, environmental stewardship, knowledge transfer, and stakeholder engagement for peace and progress. These align with the broader MSU System's emphasis on integration, excellence, and service. Annual reports highlight alignment with UN SDGs, especially SDG 4 (Quality Education) and SDG 14 (Life Below Water).

Founders and Early Leadership

Founding ties to national legislation under President Marcos and the MSU System's broader vision for Mindanao education. Early leadership included **Dr. Filemon G. Romero**, the first regular Chancellor, a noted oceanographer and environmental scientist who advanced marine research and conservation. He later contributed significantly to organizations like WWF-Philippines.

Institutional and Historical Development

From a high school adjunct, MSU-TCTO grew through program expansion, research centers (e.g., the Institute of Oceanography and Environmental Science operations starting around 1996), and infrastructure. It navigated challenges like the COVID-19 pandemic by shifting to distance learning while maintaining operations. Recent decades emphasize quality assurance, internationalization, Scopus-indexed publications, and facility upgrades.

Annual reports document steady progress in governance, student support, and community reach, even during crises.

Campus and Location

The main campus occupies **Boheh Sallang, Sanga-Sanga, Bongao, Tawi-Tawi 7500**, in a prime marine biodiversity hotspot. A Manila Liaison Office aids coordination. Recent additions include student residence halls turned over by BARMM in 2026, a new College of Law building, Halal Research Center plans, and a Medical and Wellness Services Building.

Academic Structure

Colleges and institutes include the:

- College of Arts and Social Sciences (CASS)
- College of Islamic Arts and Sciences (CIAS)
- College of Education (COED)
- College of Business, Accountancy, and Management (CBAM)
- College of Mathematical Sciences (CMS)
- College of Fisheries, Oceanography, Environmental Science, and Technology (COFEST)
- College of Computer Studies (CCS)
- College of Law (COL). It also maintains basic education units.

Academic Programs and Curriculum Offerings

Programs span undergraduate to graduate levels, including BS Marine Biology, BS Fisheries, education degrees, Islamic studies (e.g., BS Teaching Arabic, BA Islamic Studies), business, IT, mathematics, public administration, and Juris Doctor. Many hold AACCUP accreditation and CHED Certificates of Program Compliance.

Research, Extension, and Community Engagement

Research thrives in marine biodiversity, small-scale fisheries, coral reefs, and social sciences, with numerous ongoing projects and Scopus publications. Extension delivers literacy programs, capability-building, and partnerships (e.g., with barangays, AHA Learning Center, PCID for women, peace, and security). It ranks strongly in THE Sustainability Impact Ratings, topping Philippine HEIs in SDG 14.

Student Life and Organizations

Student-centered approaches include scholarships, co-curricular activities, residence halls, and support services. Organizations foster leadership, with emphasis on inclusivity and diversity.

Traditions and Culture

Campus life integrates local Tawi-Tawi and Bangsamoro cultural elements, Islamic observances, and marine-themed activities. Events like foundation anniversaries, graduations, and PRAISE Awards celebrate achievements and community.

Administration and Governance

Governed under the MSU Board of Regents per RA 8292, it features a Chancellor supported by vice chancellors for academic affairs, administration, research/extension, and planning. Chancellor Mary Joyce Z. Guinto-Sali, PhD, has led with focus on quality assurance (earning national recognition), research, and partnerships.

Chancellors, or Heads

- **Chancellor Guinto-Sali** serves as the current (4th regular) leader, noted for multi-year advancements.
- **Dr. Filemon G. Romero** was an early key figure. Details on all interim leaders remain less documented publicly.

Facilities and Landmarks

Key sites include the Henry V. Kong Gymnasium, academic halls, research facilities, and new dormitories. The campus map highlights its island setting.

Accreditation and Recognition

Strong **AACCUP Level II performance** (ranking high nationally), **ISO 9001:2015 certification** (including College of Law), CHED COPCs, and global sustainability rankings affirm quality.

Significant Milestones

- Legal foundations (1969, 1982)
- Autonomy and program growth

- Pandemic resilience
- Recent: SDG rankings, new infrastructure, AACCUP awards, international partnerships (e.g., UP), and digital initiatives.

Notable Alumni

Graduates include **Roben Abdella (first Badjao magna cum laude)**, **summa cum laude honorees like Amin Kadra A. Sarapuddin**, and professionals in education, fisheries, and leadership. Alumni associations remain active.

Notable Faculty

Figures like **Dr. Filemon G. Romero** (marine scientist), current leaders in research (e.g., **Dr. Richard N. Muallil**), and dedicated educators in various colleges contribute prominently.

Contributions to Education, Society, and the Bangsamoro Community

MSU-TCTO expands educational access, trains teachers and professionals, advances marine conservation critical to local economies, and supports peace-building and cultural continuity. It empowers communities through extension and produces graduates who serve regionally.

Legacy and Impact

Over six decades, MSU-TCTO evolved from a small high school into a dynamic institution fostering resilience, innovation, and opportunity in Tawi-Tawi. It continues to bridge traditional knowledge with modern science, contributing to a stronger Bangsamoro and Philippine south.

Research Assessment

This article incorporates official website content, annual reports (2020–2024), legal documents, and cross-verified sources. Chronology and mandates are consistent.

- **Verified Facts:** Founding laws and dates, current leadership and vision/mission, recent achievements in research and facilities, accreditation status.
- **Information Not Yet Verified:** Exhaustive past chancellor lists or complete alumni databases beyond examples.
- **Research Gaps:** Older internal archives for granular historical data, long-term impact studies, and full faculty/alumni profiles. Annual reports provide strong recent coverage but vary in depth for earlier periods.

Editorial Notice: BangsamoroPedia is a curated knowledge archive. Its pages are maintained by the editorial administrator to help ensure historical accuracy. If you would like to suggest corrections, share sources, or contribute information, please message the administrator through the official Facebook page: **Notable Muslim Filipinos**.

Retrieved from "https://wiki.maranaw.com/index.php?title=Mindanao_State_University–Tawi-Tawi_College_of_Technology_and_Oceanography&oldid=3061"